

DIGITAL FORENSICS INVESTIGATION REPORT

Case Ref: UNIV-UVM-2026-001

Subject: Academic Misconduct & Homework Fraud Investigation

at the University of UVM

Target Device: Kimberleys.Computer.E01 (Host: KIME-COMPUTER)

Lead Examiner: Charles Jeremiah Nosa

Date of Report: July 21, 2026

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- **Case Name:** University of UVM Homework Fraud Investigation (Case ID: KIMBERLEY 001)
- **Target System:** Kimberleys.Computer.E01 (Host Name: KIME-COMPUTER)
- **Primary Objective:** Investigate allegations of academic dishonesty involving students Kimberly McGee and Diane Quigley in Professor Jared Smith's course.
- **Summary of Findings:** A comprehensive digital forensic analysis of the evidence image Kimberleys.Computer.E01 and associated Instagram communication logs was conducted using the provided information and Autopsy 4.20.1. The analysis conclusively proves academic misconduct and illicit financial transaction for academic work.

A recovered/deleted PDF document titled "**Veganism and the Ethical Considerations for Animals**" was extracted from the host system. Internal text analysis revealed that the essay was authored by Diane Quigley ("By: Diane Quigley"), while file system metadata proves it was downloaded, opened, and subsequently deleted on Kimberly McGee's laptop. Social media metadata corroborates a pre-arranged contract where McGee agreed to write/provide the assignment in exchange for \$100

INCIDENT & CASE OVERVIEW

During the Spring 2026 semester at the University of UVM, Professor Jared Smith flagged students **Kimberly McGee** and **Diane Quigley** for suspected cheating. Initial suspicions indicated that one student was completing coursework for the other in exchange for monetary compensation.

Dear Investigator,

In the spring semester of 2026 at the University of UVM, two students, Kimberly McGee and Diane Quigley, were caught by their professor, Jared Smith, in an alleged cheating scandal where one student was doing the homework for another. Besides the general information, we do not have much information on the case as of now, but we have acquired McGee's computer. As an investigator, you are required to look into the motive if this happened and whether there was indeed a cheating incident. Your colleague Lorraine Sheppard already took the computer and made an image copy of it for use. On top of that, colleagues Melissa Thomas and Jessica Smith retrieved the Instagram messages for analysis. In the file folder I am sharing with you will be the Instagram metadata and the E01 file from the computer. Please make sure to analyze everything thoroughly and report what you find. As a new investigator on the team, I trust you will do a good job. Let me know if you have any questions.

Regards,

Your Boss

DFIR WORKFLOW STAGES

[1. Identification] → [2. Preservation] → [3. Acquisition] (Completed by Senior Examiner Lorraine Sheppard) [4. Examination] → [5. Analysis] → [6. Documentation] → [7. Reporting] → [8. Presentation] (Executed by Lead Investigator Charles Jeremiah Nosa)

Initial Evidence Retrieval Senior Examiner: Lorraine Sheppard imaged Kimberly McGee's laptop ('Kimberleys.Computer.E01').

Secondary Evidence Retrieval: Investigators Melissa Thomas and Jessica Smith retrieved Instagram communication data and associated metadata.

Assigned Lead Examiner: Charles Jeremiah Nosa was assigned to complete stages 4 through 8 of the Digital Forensics and Incident Response (DFIR) lifecycle.

DIGITAL FORENSICS METHODOLOGY

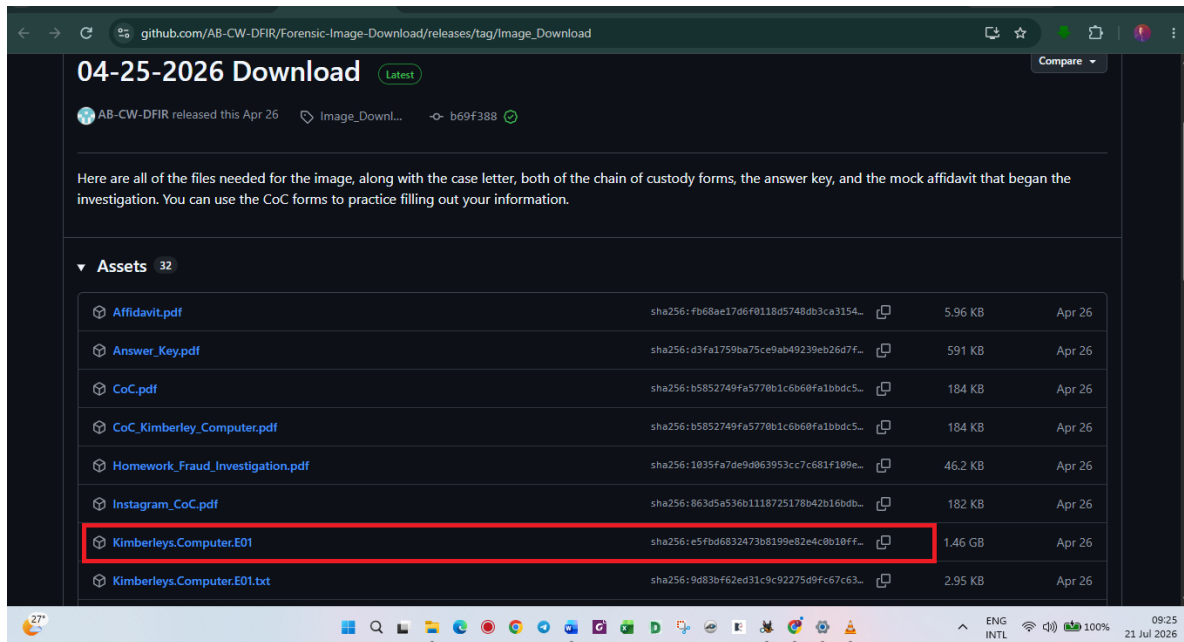
The investigation followed strict ISO/IEC 27037 digital forensics standards covering the multi-stage lifecycle

1. **Identification:** Specifying media and digital evidence related to the incident.
2. **Preservation:** Maintaining evidence integrity through cryptographic hashing.
3. **Acquisition:** Creating bit-stream forensic images (E01).
4. **Examination:** Forensic extraction of active, system, and deleted files
5. **Analysis:** Translating raw technical artifacts into legally defensible findings.
6. **Documentation:** Continuous real-time record keeping of tools, paths, and procedures.
7. **Reporting:** Synthesis of findings into a structured, technical report
8. **Presentation:** Expert presentation of evidence to decision-makers

Primary Forensic Toolset : Autopsy 4.20.1 Forensic processing, ingest module parsing, artifact extraction, and deleted file recovery

Magnet AXIOM / Cloud Load Evidence: Parsing Instagram data export packages used by my colleague.

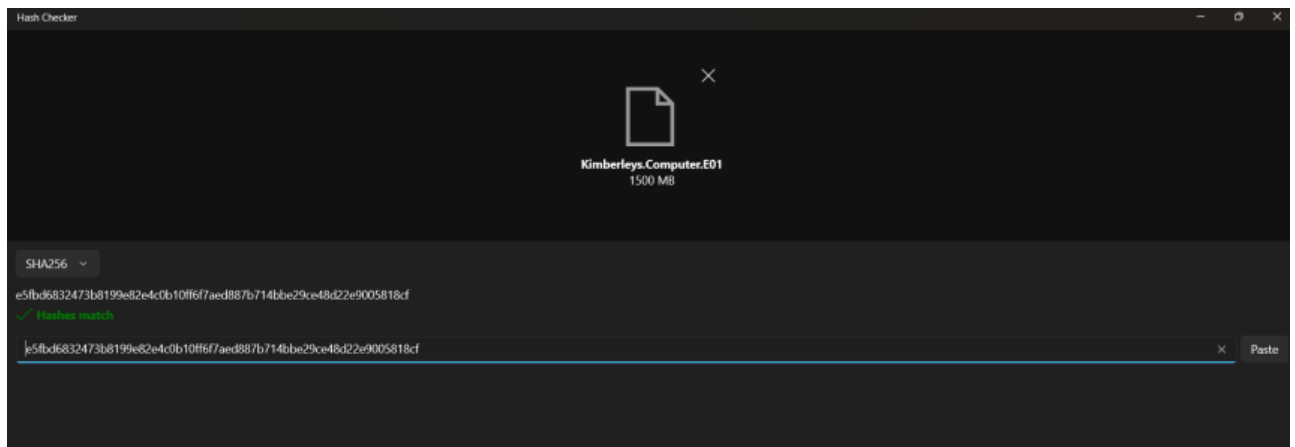
EVIDENCE ACQUISITION & CHAIN OF CUSTODY



Source file link: https://github.com/AB-CW-DFIR/Forensic-Image-Download/releases/tag/Image_Download

Kimberleys computer SHA256 Value:

sha256:e5fbd6832473b8199e82e4c0b10ff6f7aed887b714bbe29ce48d22e9005818cf



sha256: e5fbd6832473b8199e82e4c0b10ff6f7aed887b714bbe29ce48d22e9005818cf

Kimberleys computer SHA256 Value After verification:

Integrity Statement: Verification of the SHA-256 hash confirms that 'Kimberleys.Computer.E01' remained unaltered and bit-stream identical throughout the examination process.

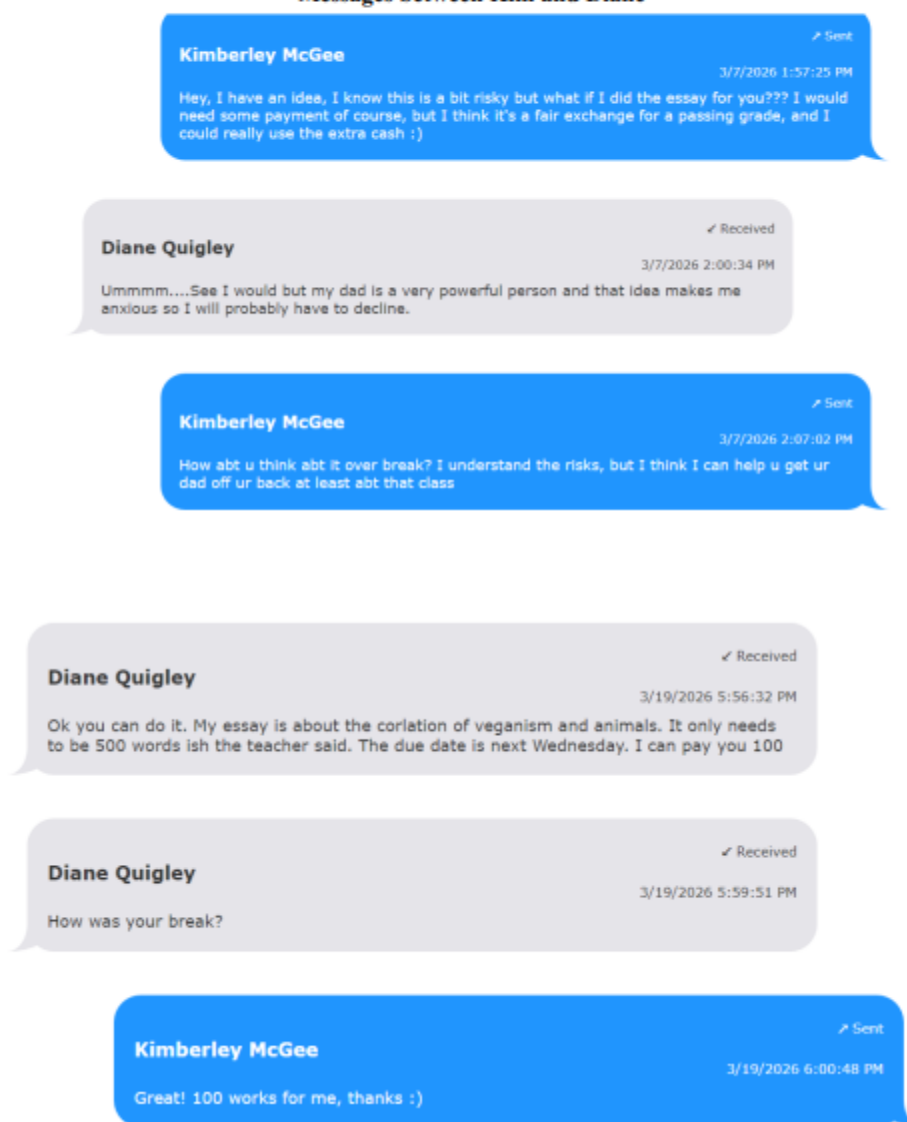
EXAMINATION & TECHNICAL ANALYSIS

Communication Artifacts (Instagram Data):

Instagram Messages

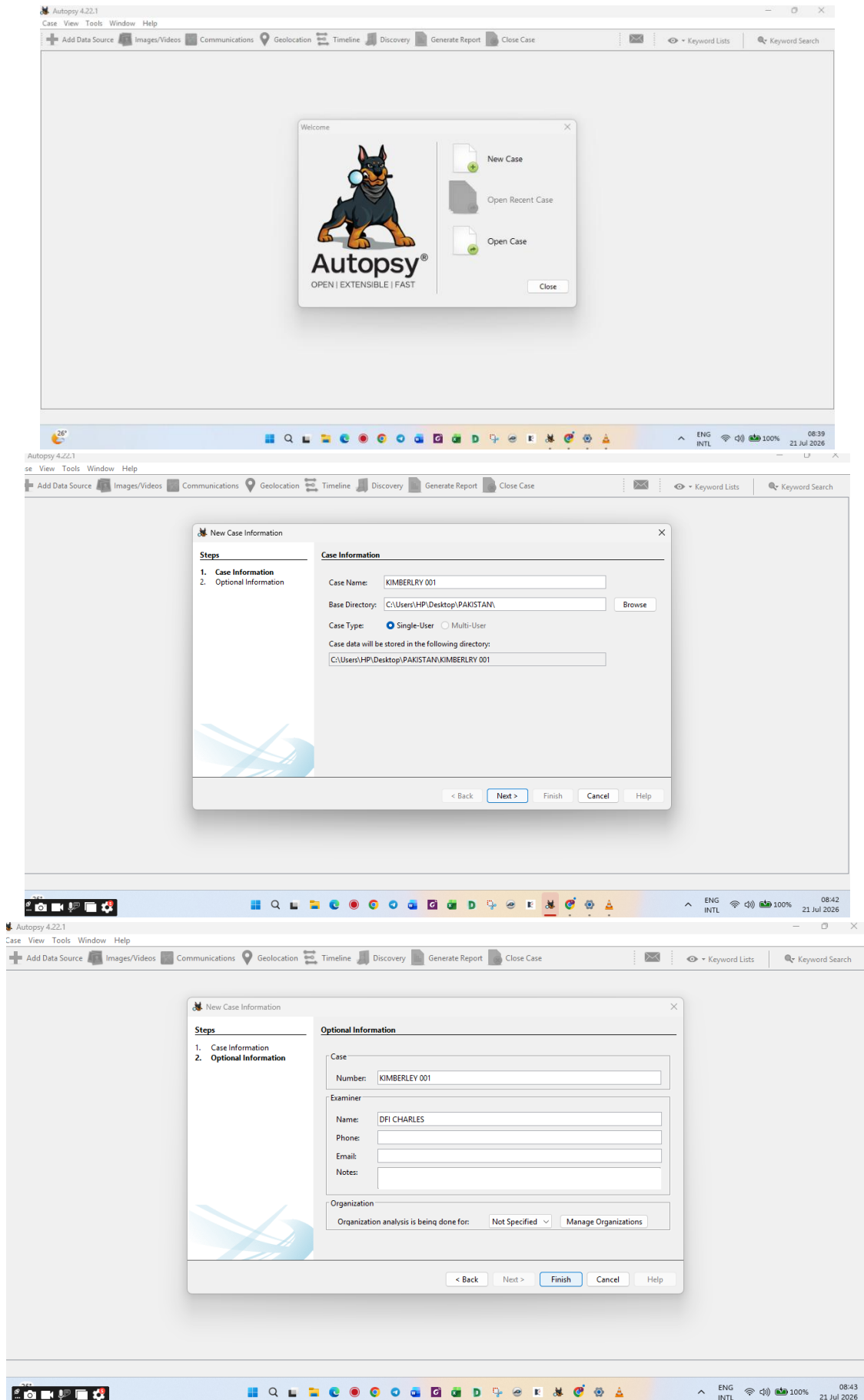
You can view the instagram data files in Axiom by going to Cloud → Load Evidence → Instagram → Download Your Data, and putting the path to the data download in the Package File section. Here you will be able to find evidence of Kim and Diane discussing exchanging money for homework. The topic of the essay is listed in these messages, which can help refine your search when looking for the essay. It can also help you look for search history about the essay topic.

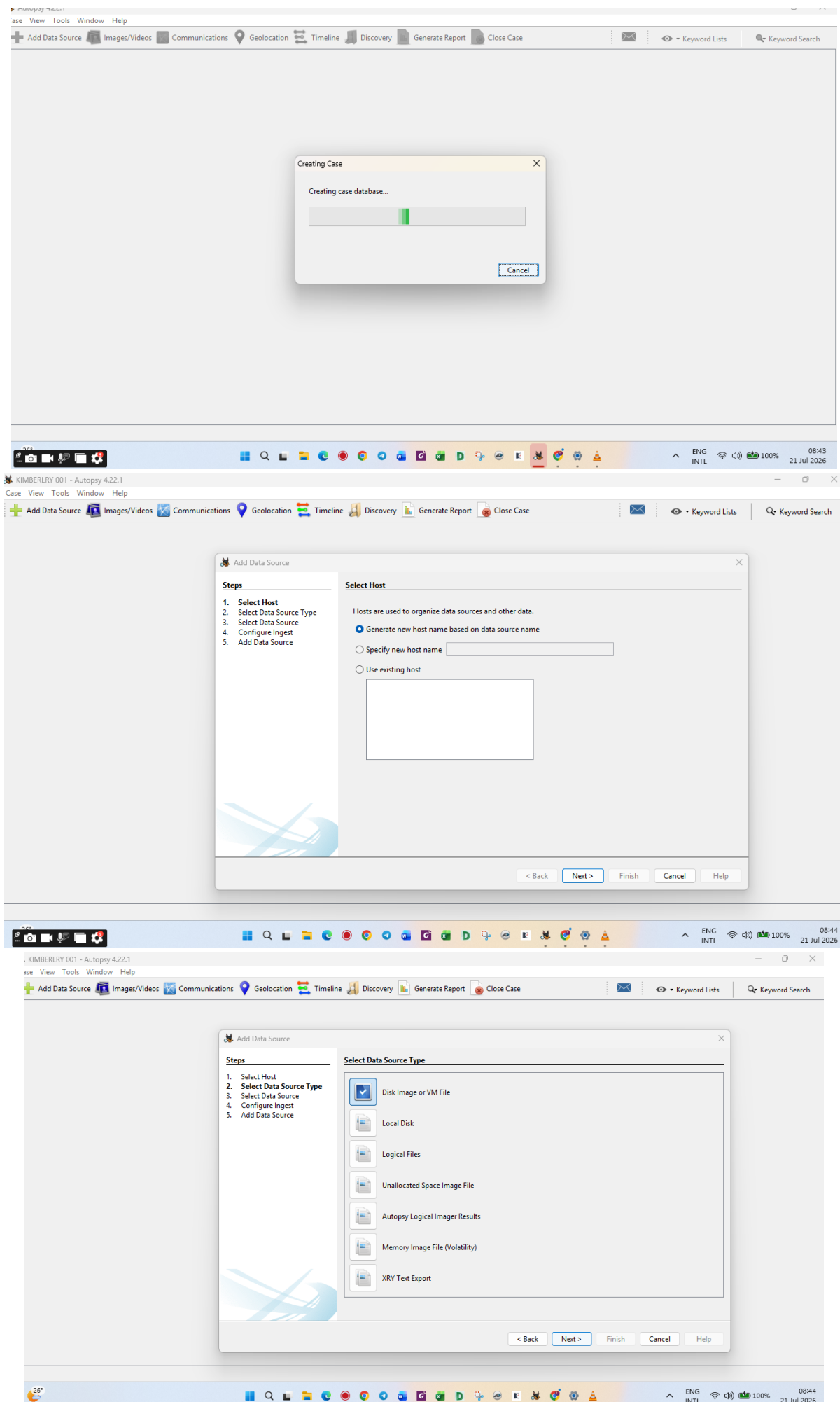
Messages between Kim and Diane

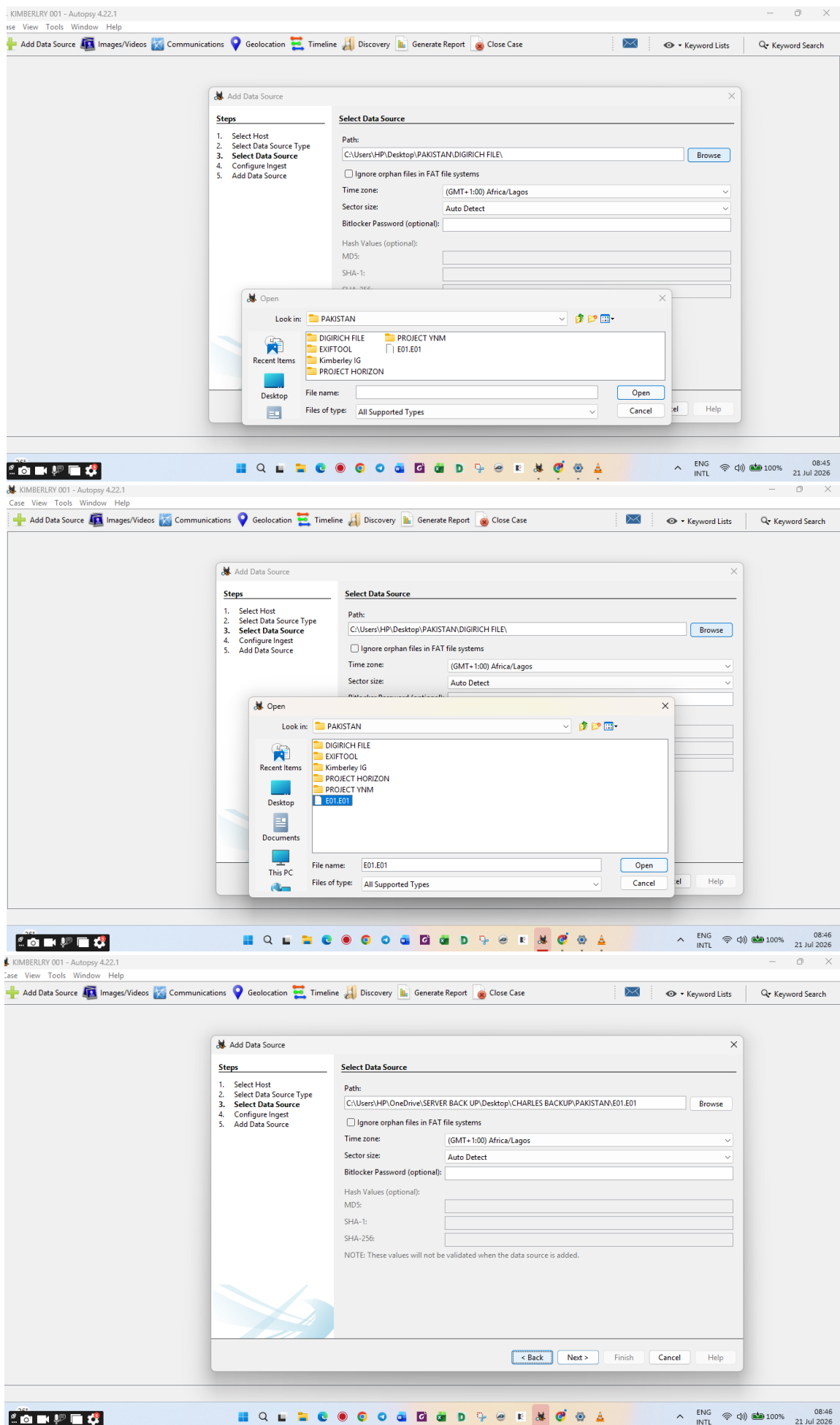


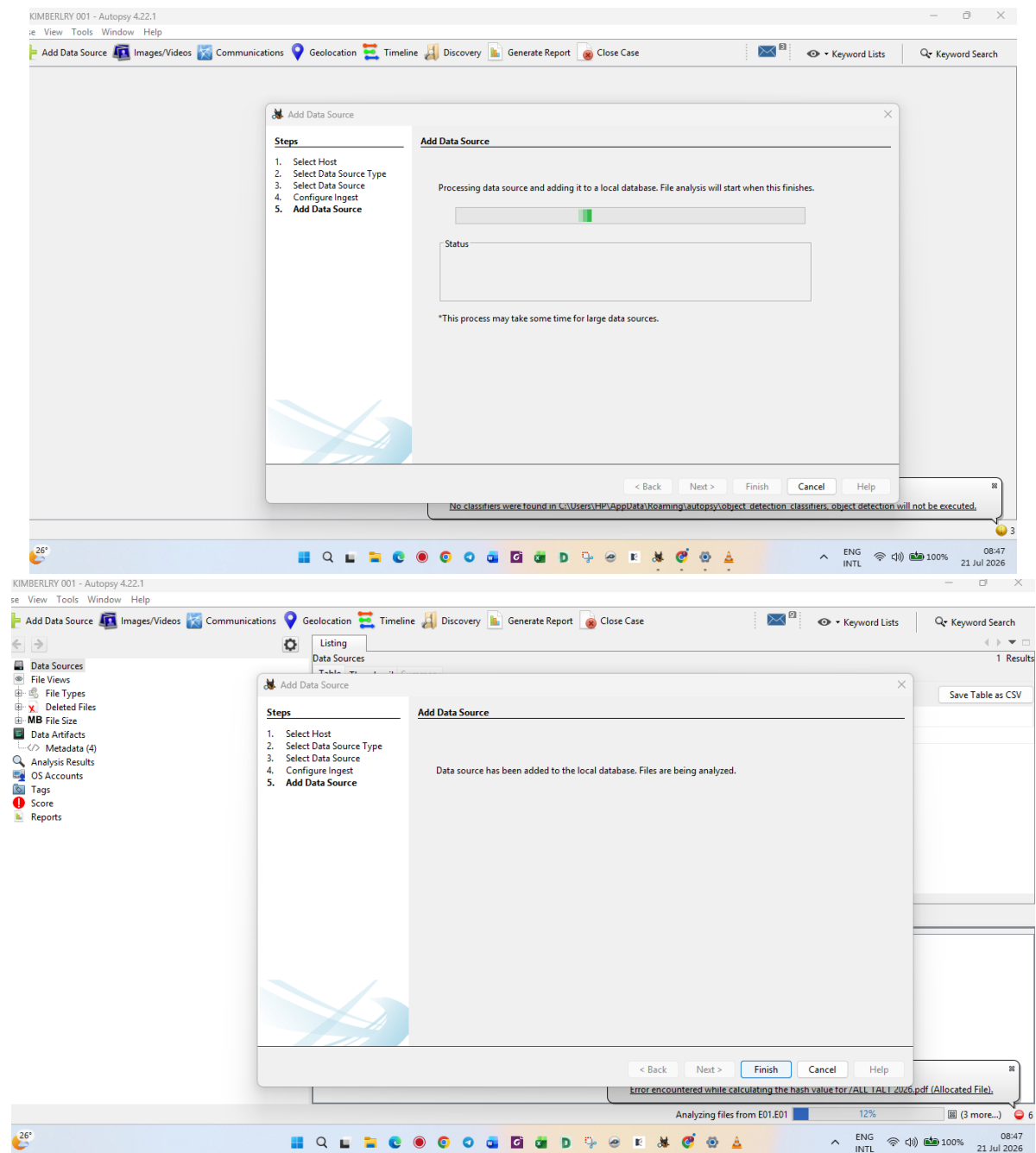
Chat evidence between Kimberley McGee and Diane Quigley

System Artifacts & Recent Documents :









Ingestion of E01

Extracted Document Analysis:

The screenshot shows the Xacta software interface with the 'Web Downloads' tab selected. The 'Listing' pane displays a table of web download results:

Source Name	S	C	O	Path	URL	Domain
TacCollectionCache.dat:Zone.Identifier				/Users/User/AppData/Local/Publishers/Bwbyk3d8Bb...		
Times Where I Helped the Environment.pdf:Zone.Ic			0	/Users/User/Downloads/Times Where I Helped the En...	https://doc-14-74-docstext.googleusercontent.com/e...	googleuse...
Writing Assignment.pdf:Zone.Identifier				/Users/User/Downloads/Writing Assignment.pdf		
SFFKDOCL.pdf:Zone.Identifier				/SOrphanFiles/SFFKDOCL.pdf		

Below the table, the 'Basic Properties' section shows details for the selected file:

Basic Properties

- Login: user
- Full Name: Kimberley McGee
- Address: S-1-5-21-4070362651-12555798-3279506043-1000
- Type: Local Admin User
- Creation Date: 2026-02-02 18:58:43 WAT
- Object Id: 792

The 'Kimberleys.Computer.E01_1 Host Details' section shows:

- Last Login: 2026-02-16 18:04:02 WAT
- Login Count: 9
- Description: Local Admin User
- Email: kmcgee1506@gmail.com
- Password Settings: Password not required
- Flag: Normal user account

Examination and Analysis 1

The screenshot shows the Xacta software interface with the 'Recent Documents' tab selected. The 'Listing' pane displays a table of recent documents:

Source Name	S	C	O	Path	Date Accessed	Data Source
ms-gamingoverlay---Ink				No preferred path found	2026-03-05 19:39:52 WAT	Kimberleys.Computer.E01
ms-settingsaccounts.Ink				No preferred path found	2026-02-16 17:56:42 WAT	Kimberleys.Computer.E01
ms-teamssystem-initiated.Ink				No preferred path found	2026-03-05 19:36:15 WAT	Kimberleys.Computer.E01
ms-gamingoverlay--kgcheck-Ink				No preferred path found	2026-02-02 17:11:02 WAT	Kimberleys.Computer.E01
Downloads.Link				C:/Users/User/Downloads	2026-03-24 00:10:48 WAT	Kimberleys.Computer.E01
Veganism and the Ethical Considerations for Anim				C:/Users/User/Downloads/Veganism and the Ethical C...	2026-03-24 00:10:48 WAT	Kimberleys.Computer.E01

The 'Recent Documents' section shows details for the selected file:

Recent Documents

Type	Value	Source(s)
Path	C:/Users/User/Downloads/Veganism and the Ethical Considerations for Animals.pdf	RecentActivity
Path ID	-1	RecentActivity
Date Accessed	2026-03-24 00:10:48 WAT	RecentActivity
Source File Path	/img_Kimberleys.Computer.E01/vol07/Users/User/AppData/Roaming/Microsoft/Windows/Recent/Veganism and the Ethical Considerations for Animals.Link	
Artifact ID	-9223372036854775790	

Examination and Analysis 2

The screenshot shows the Xacta software interface with the 'Communication Accounts' tab selected. The 'Listing' pane displays a table of communication accounts:

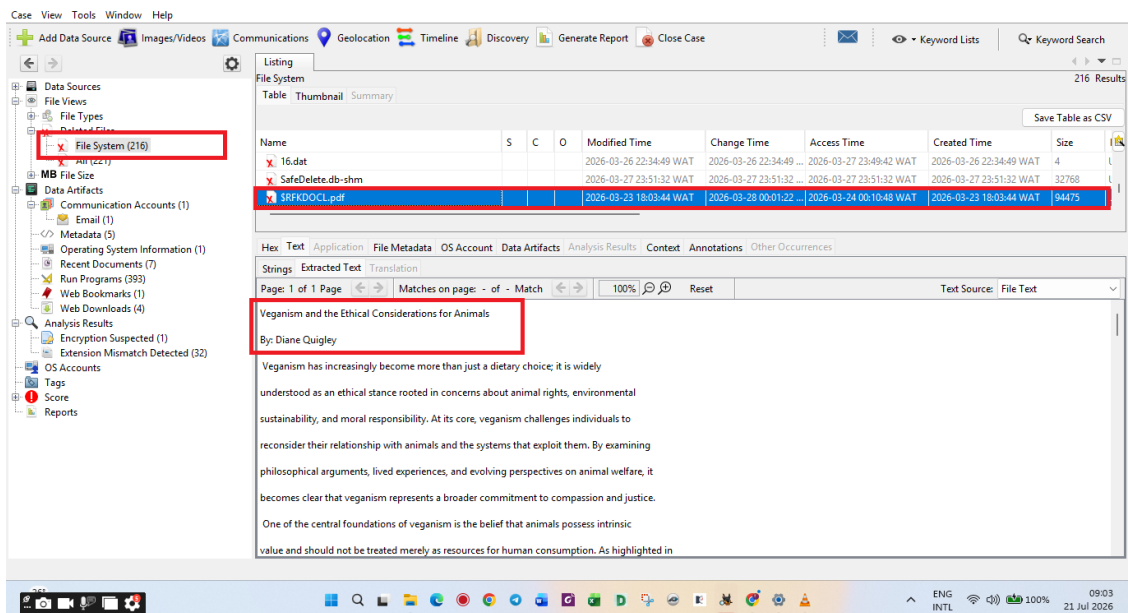
Source Name	S	C	O	Account Type	ID	Data Source
SAM			0	EMAIL	kmcgee1506@gmail.com	Kimberleys.Computer.E01

The 'Communication Accounts' section shows details for the selected account:

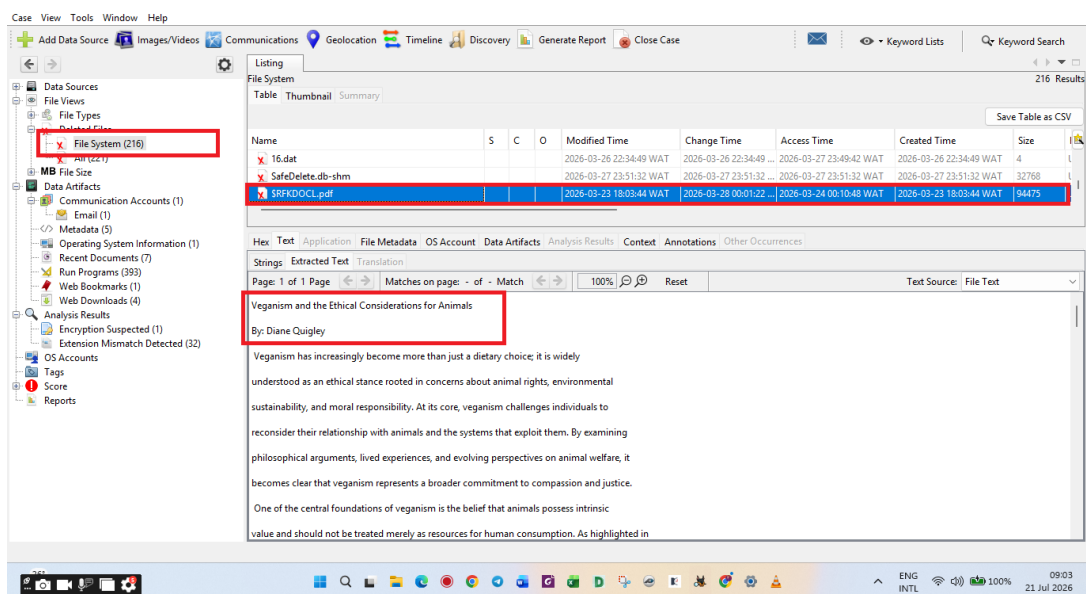
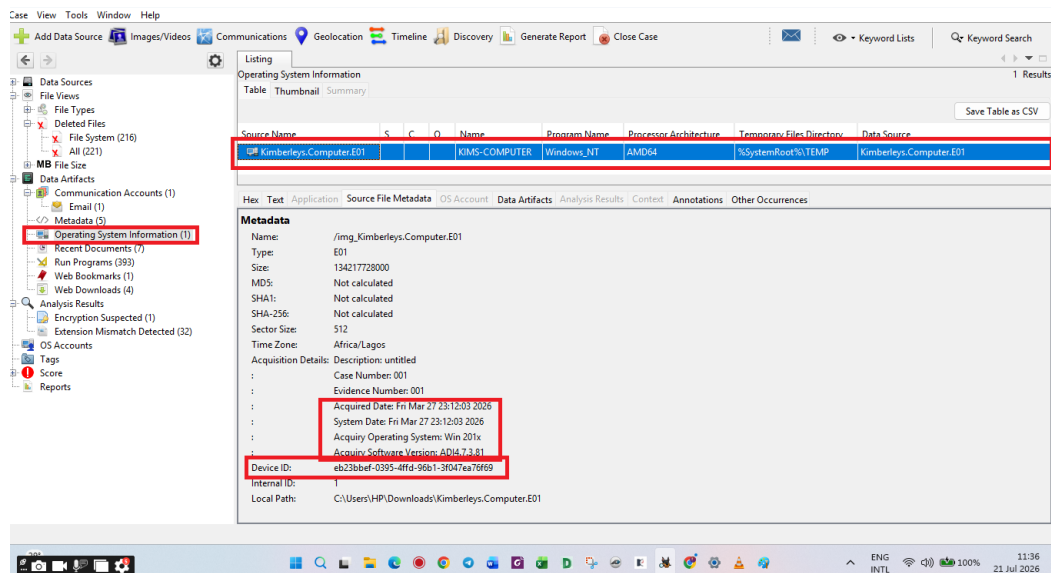
Communication Accounts

Result	of	Result

Examination and Analysis 3



Examination and Analysis 4



KEY FINDINGS

As highlighted above, those were the information gotten from the operating system. Such as the name of the system, the windows installed, processor architecture, data source, date of acquired and device ID.

1. **Premeditated Collusion:** Instagram chat metadata proves **Kimberley McGee** initiated a commercial offer to write coursework for **Diane Quigley** for \$100, which Diane Quigley formally accepted on March 19, 2026.
2. **Direct Attribution:** The document recovered from Kimberley McGee's laptop (Kimberleys.Computer.E01) contains an embedded author line identifying Diane Quigley.
3. **Execution & Access History:** Windows Shell LNK artifacts prove the file was actively downloaded and opened under Kimberley McGee's user profile on March 24, 2026
4. **Attempted Concealment:** The primary target file was deleted from the active directory structure in an effort to destroy evidence but was recovered intact via forensic carving/parsing.

CONCLUSION & RECOMMENDATIONS

Final Conclusion

The digital forensic evidence overwhelmingly validates the allegation of academic dishonesty and contract cheating between Kimberley McGee and Diane Quigley

Diane Quigley authored the paper "Veganism and the Ethical Considerations for Animals

The document was transferred to, opened on, and subsequently deleted from Kimberly McGee's computer.

Recommendation

1. **Formal Interrogation:** Call both Kimberly McGee (primary suspect/device owner) and Diane Quigley(document author) in for formal questioning regarding the method of file transfer (e.g., email, USB drive, or Instagram DMs).
2. **Cross-Examination of Communication Logs:** Proceed with parsing the retrieved Instagram metadata (Instagram_CoC.pdf) provided by investigators Melissa Thomas and Jessica Smith to establish the exact communication timeline and collusion motive
3. **Academic Sanction Review:** Submit this technical report to the University of UVM Academic Disciplinary Board as physical evidence of shared academic coursework